Evacuation Checklist

From the free guide at https://jaechung-glitch.github.io/bugout/guides/what-to-do-when-told-to-evacuate/, which lists its sources (American Red Cross, CAL FIRE, National Weather Service and Military OneSource guidance). Updated November 12, 2026.

General safety information, not medical advice or a substitute for training. In an emergency, call 911.

What to take

- [ ] Your go bag: at least 3 days of water, food and supplies
  See our bug out bag list.
- [ ] Medicines, glasses and medical devices with chargers
- [ ] IDs, insurance papers and medical records, or copies
- [ ] Cash and cards
- [ ] Phones, chargers and power banks
- [ ] A change of clothes, sturdy shoes and protective clothing
- [ ] Maps saved on your phone and on paper
- [ ] Pet food, water, leashes, carriers and records
- [ ] Baby supplies, if you need them

If you have time before you leave

- [ ] Tell someone outside the area that you're leaving and where you're going
- [ ] Lock doors and windows (for a wildfire, close them but leave them unlocked)
- [ ] Turn off utilities and unplug appliances if officials tell you to
- [ ] Bring in outdoor furniture and anything the wind could throw
- [ ] Leave a note saying when you left and where you went

On the road

- [ ] Follow the recommended evacuation route; shortcuts may be blocked or unsafe
- [ ] Watch for downed trees, washed-out roads and power lines
- [ ] Never drive into floodwater or around barricades
- [ ] Keep the radio on for updates